

CANDIDATE INTERVIEW GUIDE

Kris Watson | 25-Minute Call Template | Confidential

SECTION 1 — CORE CANDIDATE QUESTIONS (aim for 6-8 of these, ~15 min)

Pick the most relevant for the role. Don't force all of them.

1. Tell me about yourself in 2-3 sentences. What's the most important thing you want me to know?

Why ask: Reveals how they frame their own value and what they lead with.

2. What's a real area you're actively working to improve right now?

Why ask: Tests honesty. Watch for deflection or a packaged non-answer.

3. Describe the best team you've ever worked on. What made it work?

Why ask: Tells you what culture they thrive in - check if it matches yours.

4. What does success look like to you in the first 90 days here?

Why ask: Shows initiative and whether their expectations are realistic.

5. What's the one thing that would make you leave a job?

Why ask: Identifies deal-breakers early. Saves everyone time.

6. What do you need from a manager to do your best work?

Why ask: Critical for knowing whether Kris's style is a fit.

7. Walk me through how you'd approach [real challenge in this role].

Why ask: Evaluates structured thinking and prioritization.

8. Where do you see yourself in 3-5 years - and how does this role connect?

Why ask: Tests alignment between their goals and what you can actually offer.

SECTION 2 — BD INTELLIGENCE QUESTIONS (~5 min)

These feel natural in a candidate call but surface real business development value.

1. What 10 companies would you love to work for - and why?

Why ask: BD target gold. Their answers reveal which companies are aspirational in their space.

2. Where else are you currently interviewing?

Why ask: Tells you who is hiring similar talent right now. Direct market signal.

3. Do you have friends who left your current company that you still keep in touch with?

Why ask: Warm intro opportunities and potential new account entry points.

SECTION 3 — POST-CALL SCORING (fill in immediately after)

Dimension	What to look for	1-5	Notes
Self-Awareness	Honest about gaps, no deflection		
Culture Fit	Aligns with how we actually operate		
Communication	Clear, direct, listens well		
Growth Mindset	Owens their development		
Resilience	Handles ambiguity and failure well		
Team Orientation	Uplifts others, not just self		
Gut Check	Would I want to work with this person?		

